SOUTHERN UNIVERSITY · MBDA LIFT RURAL BUSINESS CENTER

Platform Product Features Brief

What has been built on the LIFT digital platform to date — for program staff, advisors, and administrators.

Prepared November 2, 2026
Audience: LIFT Center staff (internal)
Status: Live on the production platform

SECTION 1

Platform at a glance

The LIFT platform is the digital home of the Southern University MBDA LIFT Rural Business Center (award MBDA-OBC-2026-00003). It manages the full client journey for rural Louisiana small businesses — from first intake through advising, training, capital readiness, contracting support, and outcome reporting to MBDA.

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Lifecycle forms (B1–B10 templates)	User roles with scoped access	Course * collections in the LMS	Report types incl. automated LMS report	Scheduled jobs (crons)

Who the platform serves

LIFT Client
Rural business owners — onboarding, forms, courses, documents

LIFT Staff
Program team — reviews, member support, analytics, role preview

Instructor
Builds courses, runs sessions, issues certificates

Platform Admin
Full configuration, user management, Form Studio, monitoring

Additional RBAC roles exist for the shared codebase (buyer, consortium member/partner, QA reviewer, marketing staff) and can be assigned on invite.

Technology

Layer	Technology
Application	Next.js 15 (App Router) + React 19 + TypeScript, hosted on Vercel
Data	Firebase Auth, Firestore (client + Admin SDK), Storage, security rules
AI	OpenAI — intake summaries, report narratives, form assist (rules-based fallbacks everywhere)
Documents & PDF	Puppeteer-rendered branded PDFs; Firestore/Storage-backed file store
Integrations	Zoom Server-to-Server OAuth, LinkedIn, Resend/SendGrid/MS Graph email, Turnstile, UserWay, SAM.gov, Stripe

> **How to read this brief:** every feature listed is implemented in the codebase and deployed. Items marked "*needs configuration*" are built but require third-party credentials to activate in production.

SECTION 2

Feature catalog

Client experience

Feature	What it does	Where
Guided onboarding	New clients land on My Profile and complete the LIFT onboarding wizard (profile, business info, interests, documents). Every field has an inline hint explaining how the answer feeds AI-powered contracting matchmaking.	/portal/profile, onboarding wizard
Onboarding progress	Visual checklist of program steps so clients and staff see exactly where each client stands.	/portal/onboarding-progress
My LIFT forms	All assigned lifecycle forms in one place with status (draft/submitted) and PDF copies.	/portal/lift/forms
Company workspace	Users on the same company share a single company record — no duplicate data entry.	companies collection
Certificates	Numbered completion certificates with PDF download, a public verification link, and one-click LinkedIn add-to-profile / share-as-post.	/portal/sme/certificates
Help & documentation	In-app help center rewritten for LIFT: role-based quick starts, feature guide, LMS explainer, certificate verification.	/portal/help

LIFT forms engine (B1–B10 lifecycle)

Feature	What it does	Where
Form Studio	Staff build/edit/publish forms with AI assist, preview, and versioning.	/portal/admin/lift/forms
Rich controls	Standard + conversational (one-question) modes, conditional questions, signatures, file uploads, repeating tables, Likert/NPS/star ratings, calculated fields, staff-only fields, platform lookups (parishes, partners, events, clients).	components/forms
Cross-walk prefill	Answers are indexed per client and prefill later forms; profile and registration data act as fallback sources.	lib/form-builder/crosswalk
AI intake summary	B1 intake produces an AI needs assessment + recommended service plan, flagged 'pending staff review' — AI never decides eligibility.	lib/form-builder/server
Integrity	Form versions, consent-text hashes, signature references, SHA-256 content hashes, audit events, branded PDFs.	liftAudit, submissions
Worksheet QC	The Word onboarding worksheet is validated on upload with a staged correction dialog for fixable issues.	worksheet upload flow

Documents & files

Feature	What it does	Where
Role-based visibility	Every upload chooses 'Everyone' or specific roles; enforced in Firestore rules, list queries, and file download — not just hidden in the UI.	/portal/documents

Feature	What it does	Where
Document types	Configurable type list including MOU and Partner Agreements; 'Other' prompts for a custom label.	platformSettings
Company grouping	Staff can group the document list by client company; uploads carry companyId.	/portal/documents
Private storage	Portal uploads are stored private; downloads authorize through /api/files/[id] against the document's allowed roles.	/api/files/[id]
Baseline uploads	Baseline Assessment Summary uploads are stored as base64 plus extracted Markdown for AI analysis.	onboarding

Learning Management System (LMS)

Feature	What it does	Where
Courses & curriculum	Courses contain modules and sessions (video, documents, live). Instructors build curricula, reorder content, and import SCORM packages.	/portal/instructor/courses
Enrollment & progress	Clients browse the catalog, enroll, and progress is tracked per session; completion is automatic.	/portal/sme/courses
Certificates	Issued automatically on completion with unique certificate numbers, PDF rendering, and public verification.	/verify/certificate/[number]
Zoom meetings	Instructors create Zoom meetings directly on sessions (Server-to-Server OAuth). Attendance syncs attendee counts and minutes back onto the session.	Curriculum page, /api/lms/zoom/*
LinkedIn	Publishing a course auto-drafts a LinkedIn announcement for staff review; certificates share to LinkedIn profiles/posts.	linkedin_drafts pipeline
LMS dashboard	Staff analytics: enrollments by course, completion rate, Zoom attendance minutes, course status mix, certificate registry.	/portal/admin/lms
Discussions & live trainings	Per-course discussion threads, live training scheduling, and registrations.	course_discussions, course_live_trainings

Reporting & analytics

Feature	What it does	Where
LIFT reports	Six report types (monthly, quarterly, semi-annual MBDA, annual, freeform, client deep-dive) with AI narrative + deterministic fallback, PDF export, and email delivery.	/portal/admin/lift/reports
Automated training report	Weekly cron collects LMS metrics, generates the AI narrative, saves the report, and emails the PDF to staff — zero human steps.	/api/cron/lms-training-report
Deterministic metrics	All numbers come from Firestore aggregation; AI writes interpretation only.	lib/reports/data-collector

Team & administration

Feature	What it does	Where
Role-aware invites	Invite with any role; 'LIFT Staff' creates the auth account, temp password, and a team-members record grouped under LIFT Staff.	/portal/admin/team-members
Staff experience	Staff skip client onboarding, complete their profile, and get staff modules: role preview + people switchers, Team Members, grouped Documents/Opportunities, SVP partner/instructor/consortium views.	Sidebar, firestore.rules
Opportunities	Pipeline tracking with company grouping for staff.	/portal/opportunities
Submissions review	Staff review form answers, files, PDFs, and AI intake summaries.	/portal/admin/lift/submissions
Audit trail	liftAudit events on form/report/submission actions.	liftAudit collection

Marketing site

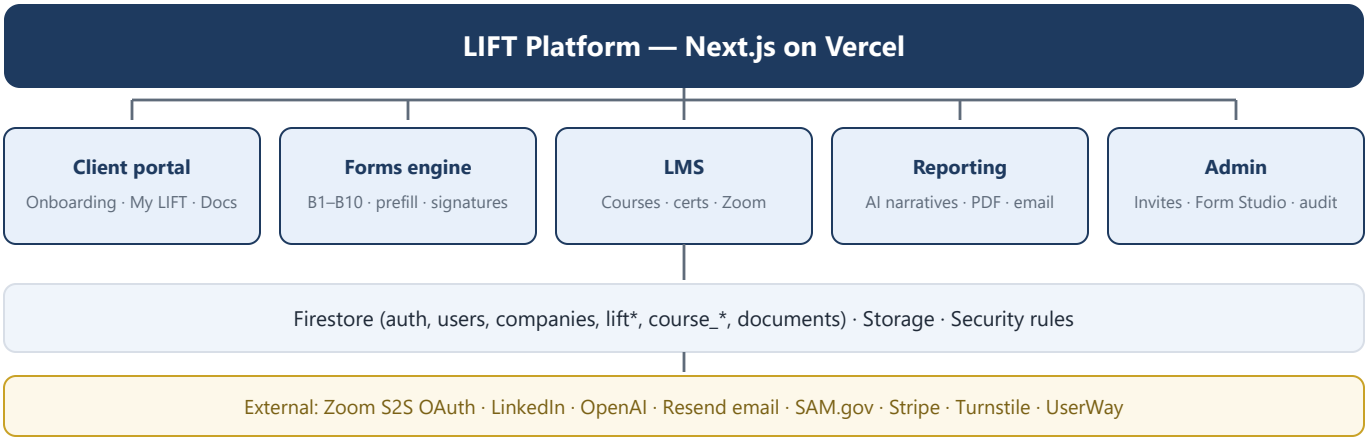
Feature	What it does	Where
LIFT branding	Southern University LIFT branding across the public site; 'no-cost' wording replaced with Help/Support Program language.	app/(marketing)
Content	Award announcement press release, services/resources pages, LIFT events catalog, hero slides.	press-releases, resources, events
Accessibility	UserWay widget planned on every page (needs NEXT_PUBLIC_USERWAY_ACCOUNT_ID).	Site layout

SECTION 3

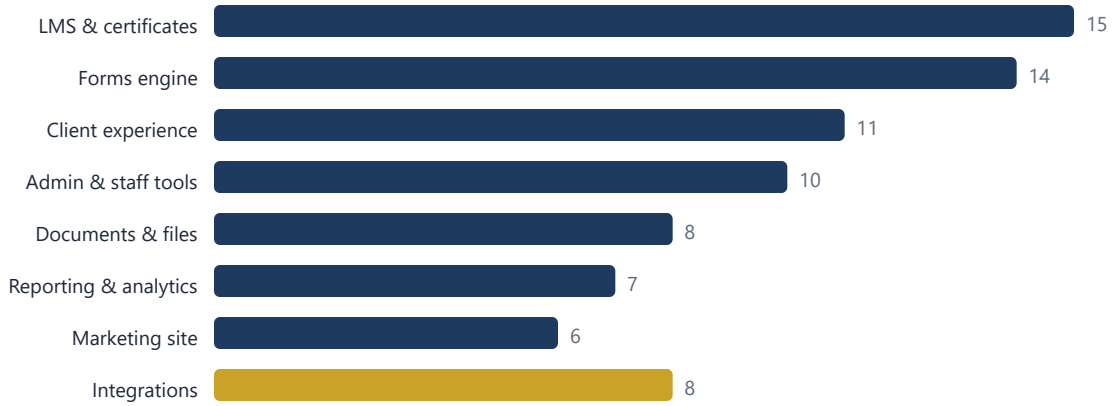
Security & data model

- **API boundary:** the browser cannot touch `lift*` collections or `lift/**` storage paths — every read/write goes through server routes that check staff/owner access, validate with Zod, rate-limit, and audit.
- **Firestore rules:** per-document role visibility on documents; staff read access to memberships, progress, opportunities, companies, and courses for analytics; owner-scoped writes elsewhere.
- **Files:** portal document uploads are private by default; downloads check the linked document's allowed roles server-side.
- **Public forms:** honeypot + optional Turnstile CAPTCHA; signed-out submissions still produce versioned, hashed records.
- **Secrets:** Firebase Admin, Zoom, OpenAI, Resend, and cron secrets live in environment variables only.

Platform module map

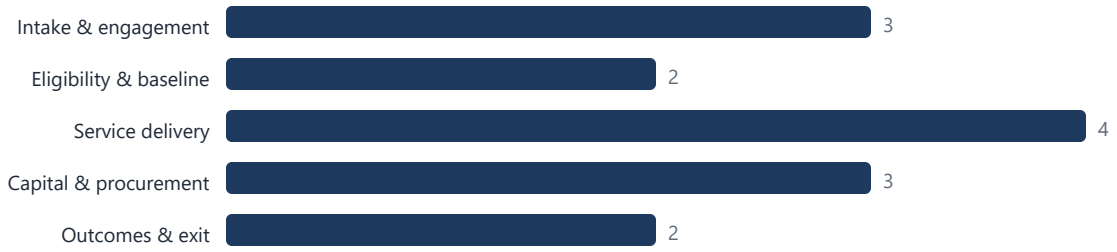


Features delivered by domain (approximate count of distinct capabilities)



Counts group related sub-features; intended to show coverage, not precision.

Client lifecycle coverage (B1–B10 forms implemented)



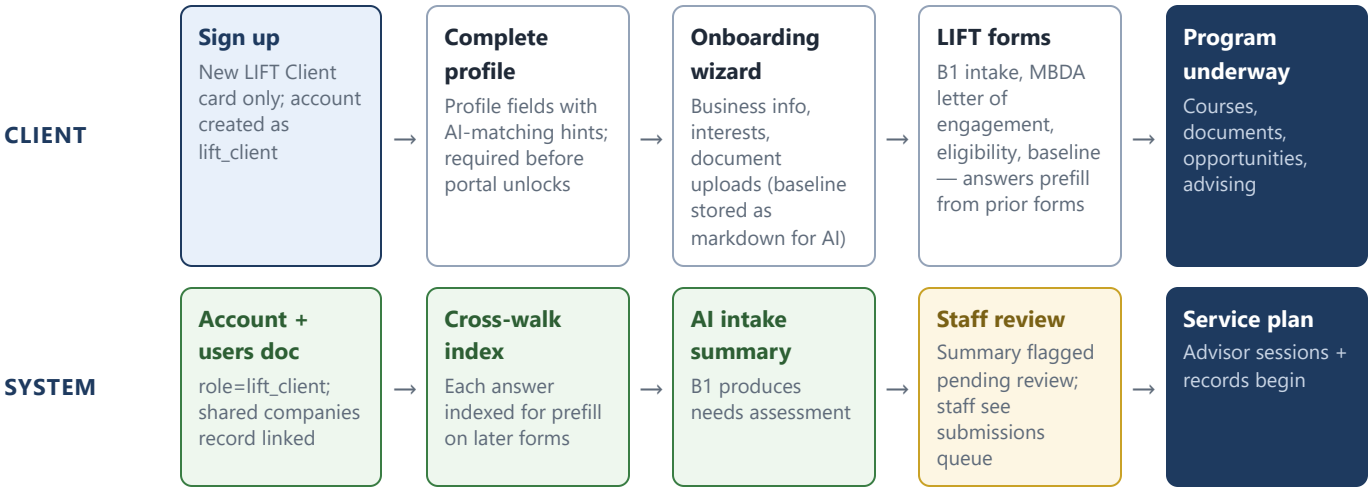
Every stage of the MBDA client lifecycle has at least one live form template.

SECTION 4

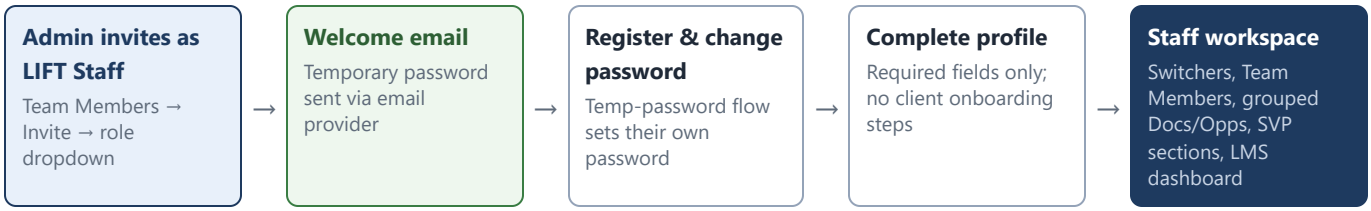
User journeys

Entry / role · User step · Decision / staff review · Automated · Outcome

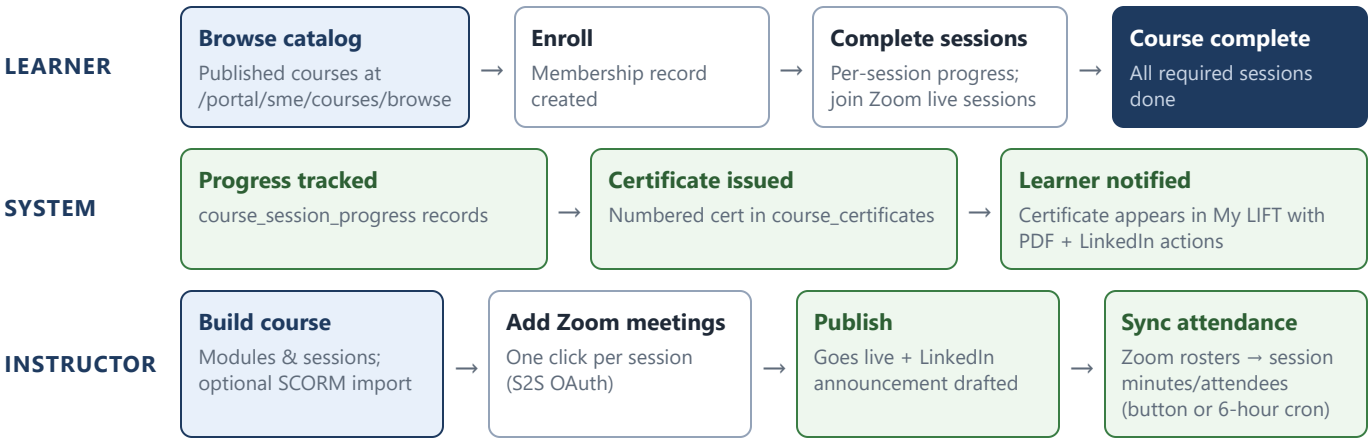
Journey 1 — LIFT client onboarding



Journey 2 — LIFT staff invite & first login

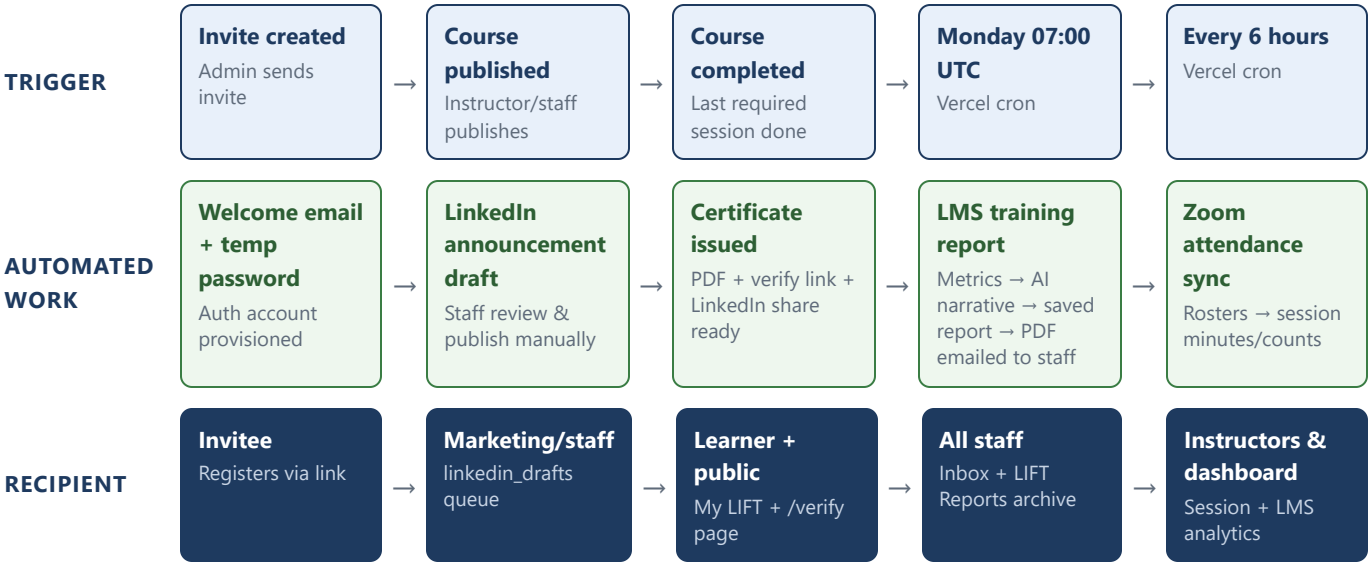


Journey 3 — Training & certification



Journey 4 — Notifications & automated reporting

How events move through the platform without staff intervention. Email delivery uses the configured provider (Resend preferred; SendGrid, Microsoft Graph, or Azure SMTP also supported).



> **Nothing posts externally without a human.** LinkedIn announcements land as drafts; the AI intake summary is flagged 'pending staff review'; reports are generated automatically but stored for audit.

LIFT lifecycle forms (B1–B10)

B1 Intake · B2 MBDA LOE · B3 Rural eligibility · B4 Baseline · B5 Service plan · B5 Advisor log · B6 Workshop reg. · B6 Workshop feedback · B7 Capital readiness · B8 Capability library · B8 Proposal response · B9 Outcome check-in · B10 Impact consent · B10 Exit survey

SECTION 5

Status & open items

Needs third-party configuration to activate

- **Zoom live calls** — built, but needs Server-to-Server OAuth credentials (Settings → Zoom Integration). Setup: docs/lms-integrations-setup.md.
- **Resend/email** — keys are configured in the dashboard; verify first send.
- **UserWay widget** — account ID env var is empty.
- **OpenAI** — AI narratives/summaries; deterministic fallbacks run without it.

Known backlog

- Legacy KDM marketing directories and blog content to be removed from this deployment's navigation.
- Staff access to a few admin-only actions on Team Members (welcome email resend, readiness scan) still requires platform_admin.
- First automated LMS report fires on the next Monday cron, or manually via GET /api/cron/lms-training-report with the cron secret.

> Questions or corrections: update this brief by regenerating it — `npx tsx scripts/generate-features-brief.ts` — the script renders to `docs/LIFT_Product_Features_Brief.pdf`.